Tour Studios on TikTok: the strategy

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1. The bet

TikTok becomes Tour Studios' main stage from this week, with Instagram second. TikTok reaches 47.8 million Nigerian adults, up 43.4% in a year; Instagram reaches 10.0 million and fell 6.1% (DataReportal figures, via Vanguard). Our films still go to Instagram first.

The plan is four recurring formats, each with a fixed shape the audience learns to expect, cut from what we already shoot. We post five times a week from launch and step up for Detty December. Every video is built to be watched to the end and sent to a group chat, because those are the signals TikTok weights most.

The account is also our shop window. Brands on the 1,000-company list see a format working with a real audience, then pay for an episode or a season of it.

By 31 January 2027 we want:

- 60 or more videos published, on schedule
- two formats whose completion and share rates stay above the account average for six weeks running
- two brands paying for a Tour Studios format
- at least one in ten views on the weekend guide coming from TikTok search

2. What TikTok rewards right now

Each video earns its own reach. TikTok says its For You feed ranks on what viewers do and what the video says (captions, sounds, hashtags), with device settings counting for less. Follower count and past hits are not direct factors, and finishing a longer video is a strong signal (Vanguard).

What that means for us:

- **Watched to the end, then sent on.** Completion and watch time lead, followed by shares, saves and comments (eClincher). TikTok publishes no weights, so any "40% of the algorithm" figure online is a guess (PostEverywhere).
- **Long is fine if it holds.** About 86% of TikToks run under a minute, yet Buffer found videos over 60 seconds got 43.2% more reach and 63.8% more watch time (Buffer, via Quso). Our documentary cuts can run long. A slow one will not travel.

- **Volume raises the ceiling, not the floor.** Across 11.4 million posts, moving from one post a week to two to five lifted views per post by up to 17%, and eleven or more by up to 34%. The median stayed near 500 views at every rate (Buffer).
- **People search it.** 49% of US consumers used TikTok as a search engine in 2026, up from 41% in 2024 (Adobe). There is no Nigerian figure; our own Search share in analytics will tell us.
- **Real beats polished.** TikTok's 2026 forecast names "Reali-TEA": brands win by showing real experiences over curated perfection (Social Media Today). Tour Studios already shoots this way.

Two limits shape the rest of the plan. TikTok's Creator Rewards programme does not list Nigeria among its eligible countries, so the account earns through brands (Vanguard). And a business account can only pick music from TikTok's Commercial Music Library, on organic posts too (Soundstripe).

3. Who we make it for

We make for young Lagos first: the people who go out, and the people who make the city's culture. The young art community is already our strongest audience, so it anchors the account.

Who	What they want from us	What they do with a good video
Young creatives and the art crowd, 18 to 28	Their scene taken seriously, and themselves in it	Comment, stitch, tag friends
Young professionals on the Island, 24 to 35	Where to go this weekend, and whether it is worth the money	Save it, send it to the group chat, book
The diaspora home for December	What Lagos feels like now, before they land	Search, save, follow for the season
Brands and their agencies	Proof that we hold attention in their category	Brief us

We never make a video for the last row. Brands watch over the audience's shoulder, and they buy what the first three rows love.

4. The four formats

The account runs on four formats, like channels on the site. Each keeps one shape every time, so a viewer knows what they are watching within a second. Fewer formats also tell TikTok clearly who we are for.

Format	Length	Per week	The signal it chases	What a brand can buy
This Weekend	30 to 45 s	1, Thursday	Saves, shares, search	Presenting partner for a month
At the Door	20 to 45 s	2	Comments, shares	An episode shot at their event or venue
Tour With…	60 to 120 s	1	Watch time, follows	An episode on their founder or maker
The Series	60 to 120 s	1, when a season is running	Follows, completion	A whole season

This Weekend

Three things worth leaving the house for in Lagos this weekend, each with the area and the price in naira. It is the useful one: people save it and send it to whoever they are going out with. The caption points to the Tour app for booking.

At the Door

One question, asked at the door of whatever event or place we are covering that week. Everyone gets the same question that week, into the same mic with a Tour Studios mic flag, the cube a TV reporter carries. Questions should start an argument: "Island or Mainland for a first date? Defend it." This format turns every paid event job into series content.

Tour With…

A day with one person: an artist, a chef, a designer, a DJ. Cut from our longer films, it opens on the most surprising thing they say and ends on a line, not a logo. The first episodes come from pieces we already have (Dada Gallery, INES, Discover Slawn) where the footage allows a vertical cut.

The Series

A season about one place or brand, built like a TV show: the same people every week, one problem per episode, a running count on screen ("Episode 3 of 12"). The ATMOS treatment, Opening Soon, is the template. Episodes go into a TikTok playlist so a new viewer can start from episode one.

One slot a week stays free for same-night cuts: when something happens in the culture, a raw 15 to 30 second cut goes up within hours. When no season is running, that slot replaces The Series.

5. House style

These are the rules every cut follows, so the account looks like one channel whoever edits it.

The first two seconds

- Open on the best moment in the piece, even if it happens in the middle. A person mid-sentence beats a wide shot.
- A title on screen from the first frame that says what this is: "₦40k date night in Ikoyi. Worth it?"
- No logo sting, no black frame, no "hey guys". Sound starts on frame one.

Length

Use the lengths in the formats table, then cut to the last line that earns its place. If the retention graph drops off a cliff at the same point twice, that part goes in the next edit.

Captions

- Burned-in subtitles on every spoken word, proofread before export. Pidgin stays as spoken; Yoruba and Igbo get an English line.
- One typeface: the Tour Studios house sans, semibold, sentence case, white with a soft shadow. Never TikTok's default text style.
- Two lines at most, in the lower middle of the frame, clear of the bottom fifth and the right-hand strip where TikTok puts its buttons and caption.
- Calm, broadcast-style subtitles, like a documentary on TV. No word-by-word pop-up captions and no emoji in the frame.

The TV-station look

Yes, it carries over, lightly. The site is built like a broadcaster, and TikTok is where people will meet it first.

- A small channel bug in the top-left corner, below the app's top bar: the Tour Studios mark and the format name. Same place on every video.
- A lower-third name strap for anyone on screen, in the site's broadcast style.
- A one-second end card with the format name and episode number, cut so the video loops back cleanly into its opening.
- The mic flag on At the Door is the look in physical form.
- Cover frames carry the format name and episode title, so the profile grid reads like a TV schedule.

Sound

- Original audio first: voices, the room, the city. Music sits under montage only, never under someone talking.
- Music comes from TikTok's Commercial Music Library, or from Lagos artists who give us written permission covering commercial use on TikTok. Licensed tracks go in before upload, and we complete TikTok's music confirmation when posting (Soundstripe).
- Artists want TikTok placements: every serious release in Nigeria is now planned around the app, a Lagos promoter told NAN (Premium Times). New Lagos music in our videos is a favour to them as well as to us.
- A short Tour Studios sound ident, composed for us, closes every video. Over time people recognise us by ear.

Picture

Shoot vertical where we can; when we reframe a 16:9 film, reframe on purpose, shot by shot. Handheld and observational. Keep skin honest in Lagos light. No stock footage, and no AI-generated faces or voices.

6. Posting rhythm

Five videos a week from launch, the top of Buffer's recommended two to five, then daily from 14 December to 4 January. The same day for the same format, so regular viewers know when to look.

Day	Format
Monday	At the Door
Tuesday	Tour With…
Wednesday	The Series, or a same-night cut
Thursday	This Weekend
Friday	At the Door
Saturday and Sunday	Same-night cuts from events, when we have them

Published studies on the best time to post disagree with each other, and none covers Nigeria. For the first four weeks we alternate between 13:00 and 19:30 Lagos time, then keep whichever brings more views in the first 24 hours.

A slot moves before quality drops. If Friday's cut is not ready, it goes out Saturday; the format never breaks its shape to make a deadline.

7. Getting found

The For You feed does most of the work, but search, comments and the people we feature carry a video further.

Search

- Name things the way people type them: "things to do in Lagos this weekend", "date spots in Lagos", "art galleries in Lagos", "Detty December 2026".
- Put that phrase in three places: in the first line of the caption, in the on-screen title, and said out loud early in the video, since TikTok transcribes speech.
- Three to five specific hashtags, such as #lagos, #thingstodoinlagos, #lagosart. Never #fyp.
- Tag the location on every video shot at a venue.

Comments

- Reply within the first hour, in Tour Studios' voice.
- Pin the comment that starts the best argument.
- Answer the best comment of the week with a video reply. It is a free extra post with a ready-made audience.

- Turn on Stitch and Duet for At the Door, so people can give their own answer to the question.
- Questions people ask in the comments become next week's This Weekend picks or At the Door questions.

The people we feature

Send the finished cut to everyone in it on the day it goes up, tag them, and ask them to share it. An artist's own followers are the warmest audience we can reach.

The profile

- One playlist per format, so a new viewer can binge.
- Three pinned videos: the best of each of our three strongest formats, swapped as better ones arrive.
- A bio link to tourstudio.tv for brands, and the Tour app in the caption of every This Weekend.

Other platforms

TikTok gets each video first. Reels and YouTube Shorts get the same cut from the clean master file, never a TikTok-watermarked download. YouTube also gets the longer cuts of Tour With… and The Series.

8. How it makes money

We sell formats, not posts. A brand that pays for an At the Door episode buys a show with a known shape and a known audience, which is worth more than a one-off video.

The proof is Subway Takes. It began as a low-cost show with one fixed device, a microphone clipped to a MetroCard, and one question, "So, what's your take?" It now has 1.3 million TikTok followers and an Emmy nomination (NSS). In 2026 Toyota hired its host to front a four-episode branded talk show, Pit Stop Tonight (The Hollywood Reporter).

What a brand buys	What they get	Label on TikTok
An At the Door episode	One or two cuts filmed at their event or venue, plus selects for their own channels	Paid partnership
This Weekend, presented by them	Their name on the title card for a month. One of the three picks can be theirs, only if we would pick it anyway	Paid partnership

What a brand buys	What they get	Label on TikTok
A Tour With… episode	A 60 to 120 second film on their founder or maker, plus cutdowns	Paid partnership
A season of The Series	Six to twelve episodes about their place or launch: the ATMOS model	Paid partnership

The rules for paid work:

- **No more than one paid video in five**, so the feed stays ours and stays worth watching.
- **Always disclosed.** Paid videos use TikTok's commercial content setting, choosing "Branded content", which adds a Paid partnership label. TikTok may remove or restrict posts that should be disclosed and are not (TikTok).
- **ARCON approval.** ARCON says every advert, including creators' and influencers' adverts on social media, needs its approval before it runs, and unapproved adverts can go to the Advertising Offences Tribunal (BrandCom). The contract should make the brand responsible for approval on any paid video. Get a lawyer's view on whether our sponsored editorial counts as an advert.
- **A report within seven days.** Every brand gets one page: views, average watch time, share of viewers who watched to the end, shares, saves, and what people said in the comments. That page is what sells the next season.

9. The first 30 days, into Detty December

We launch on Monday 16 November with eight videos already finished, learn for three weeks, then go daily for December, when the diaspora is home and Lagos goes out most.

This week: set up and bank (12 to 15 November)

- [ ] Settle the decisions in section 12
- [ ] Set up the account: name, bio, profile picture, link, one playlist per format
- [ ] Build the edit template: caption style, channel bug, name strap, end card
- [ ] Order the mic flag and brief a composer on the sound ident (a plain mic and no ident until they arrive)
- [ ] Finish eight videos before the first post: three Tour With… recuts, three At the Door, one This Weekend, one spare

Week 1: launch (16 to 22 November)

- [ ] Publish five, on the rhythm in section 6
- [ ] Reply to every comment

- [ ] Pin three videos
- [ ] Shoot At the Door at two weekend events

Week 2: learn (23 to 29 November)

- [ ] Publish five
- [ ] Test one thing: a question on screen against a line from the person as the opening
- [ ] Draft the December offer for brands: At the Door at their December event, and This Weekend presented by them
- [ ] Send it to the first 20 brands with December events, with our first two weeks' numbers

Week 3: December starts (30 November to 6 December)

- [ ] First weekly review, Monday 30 November
- [ ] Publish six
- [ ] This Weekend becomes the December guide, still every Thursday
- [ ] Two search-led videos for people flying home, such as "Landing in Lagos for December: where to go first"

Week 4: first paid episode (7 to 13 December)

- [ ] Publish six or seven
- [ ] Film the first paid At the Door at a brand's December event
- [ ] Set the account baselines once 20 videos are up (section 10)
- [ ] Book the same-night shoots for the peak weeks

Peak: daily (14 December to 4 January)

- [ ] Publish every day, plus same-night cuts from events
- [ ] Point every This Weekend at Tour's December listings in the app
- [ ] Send each brand its report within seven days of its video
- [ ] Season review on Monday 4 January: keep the formats that worked and plan the first quarter

10. Measuring it

We judge each video against our own account, not against other people's numbers. Thirty minutes every Monday, with the editor, the social media manager and Folu.

For every video, log five numbers from TikTok's analytics: average watch time, the share who watched to the end, shares, saves, and where views came from (For You, Search, profile, following). Once 20 videos are up, the median of each becomes the baseline.

The rules:

- **Follow up on a hit within 48 hours.** A video with three times the median views or shares gets a follow-up: a part two, a video reply, or the same question at another door.
- **Rework, then drop.** A format that sits in the bottom third for completion and shares six episodes running gets reworked once. If the next three do not move, it goes.
- **Change one thing a week:** the opening, the length or the posting time. Change two and we will not know which worked.
- **Read the retention graph.** Where viewers leave is a note for the editor, more useful than any opinion in the room.
- **Follower count is not the weekly scoreboard.** The January targets in section 1 are.

11. What we won't do

- Dance trends, lip-syncs and chart-song memes. They are not us, and a business account cannot use the songs anyway.
- Word-by-word pop-up captions, emoji captions, stock footage, AI voices or AI faces.
- Rage bait, or laughing at the people on camera. They are the reason anyone watches.
- #fyp, or stacks of hashtags.
- Posting TikTok-watermarked files to Instagram, or Instagram files to TikTok.
- A paid video without the Paid partnership label.
- Filming people without their agreement. Everyone featured agrees on camera or in writing; a bystander who becomes the subject of a shot is cut or blurred.
- Posting just to fill a slot.

12. Decisions for Folu

Six calls to make this week, before the first post.

Decision	Recommendation	Why
One account or two	One account under the Tour Studios name, with the Tour app linked from captions	Two accounts split the audience and the signal. Our films already go out as @officialtourng on Instagram, so decide whether the TikTok handle matches it or tourstudio.tv
Business or personal account	Business	We will run paid partnerships and need the commercial tools. The cost is chart music, which this style does not use
Who presents At the Door	One recurring host	People follow a face. Subway Takes is its host as much as its question
Prices for the four brand products	A rate card before the December offer goes out in week 2	The December offer cannot go out without it
Caption typeface	Confirm the Tour Studios house sans for the edit template	Every video uses it, so it is set once
ARCON	A lawyer's view before the first paid video in week 4	Whether sponsored editorial needs ARCON approval decides who files it and when

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